

CORPORATE HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY MANUAL

Effective Date: January 1, 2024

Confidential Internal Document

1. Introduction and Purpose

1.1 Purpose of the Handbook

The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, or deviate from these policies as circumstances dictate. This document

supersedes all previous employee handbooks and any inconsistent verbal or written policy statements. The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, or deviate from these policies as circumstances dictate. This document supersedes all previous employee handbooks and any inconsistent verbal or written policy statements. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

1.2 At-Will Employment

Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company,

other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company, other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

1.3 Equal Employment Opportunity

The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training,

promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

1.4 Disability Accommodations

In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable

accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

2. Workplace Conduct

2.1 Code of Conduct

The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a

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2.2 Anti-Harassment Policy

The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. This

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2.3 Anti-Bullying Policy

The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace environment is equally detrimental. Employees who witness or experience bullying are encouraged to report it to their supervisor or Human Resources. The Company is committed to fostering a supportive and safe environment for all employees. The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace

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2.4 Dress Code and Grooming

Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role, location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to determine the appropriateness of an employee's attire and may require an employee to return home to change if their clothing is deemed inappropriate. Time spent changing will not be compensated. Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role,

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2.5 Drug and Alcohol-Free Workplace

The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations,

such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations, such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

3. Attendance and Leave Policies

3.1 Working Hours and Attendance

Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company

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3.2 Paid Time Off (PTO)

The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. This policy is strictly enforced and is a

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3.3 Sick Leave

In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our

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3.4 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250 hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250

hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

3.5 Bereavement Leave

The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate

family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

4. Compensation and Performance

4.1 Payroll Practices

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement

plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

4.2 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized

overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

4.3 Performance Reviews

The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the

employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other employment decisions. The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other employment decisions. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

4.4 Salary Administration

The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary discussions are confidential between the employee, their manager, and Human Resources. Pay increases are not guaranteed and are typically based on merit, promotions, or significant changes in job responsibilities. The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary discussions are confidential between the employee, their manager, and Human Resources. Pay increases are not guaranteed and are typically based on merit, promotions, or significant changes in job responsibilities. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The

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5. Technology and Information Security

5.1 Acceptable Use of Technology

The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the

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5.2 Social Media Policy

The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the social media policy may lead to disciplinary action. The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the

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5.3 Confidentiality and Data Protection

During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees are obligated to maintain the strict confidentiality of this information and use it only for legitimate business purposes. Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals, either internally or externally, without proper authorization. This obligation of confidentiality continues even after the employee's employment with the Company has ended. Employees must take all reasonable precautions to protect confidential information from unauthorized access, loss, or theft. This includes securing physical documents, using strong passwords, and being cautious of phishing scams or social engineering attempts. During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees

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5.4 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen,

or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen, or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

6. Introduction and Purpose

6.1 Purpose of the Handbook

The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, or deviate from these policies as circumstances dictate. This document supersedes all previous employee handbooks and any inconsistent verbal or written policy statements. The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, or deviate from these policies as circumstances dictate. This document supersedes all previous employee handbooks and any inconsistent verbal or written policy statements. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines

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6.2 At-Will Employment

Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company, other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company, other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles

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6.3 Equal Employment Opportunity

The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and

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6.4 Disability Accommodations

In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the

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7. Workplace Conduct

7.1 Code of Conduct

The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times.

This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

7.2 Anti-Harassment Policy

The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or

name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

7.3 Anti-Bullying Policy

The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace environment is equally detrimental. Employees who witness or experience bullying are encouraged to report it to their supervisor or Human Resources. The Company is committed to fostering a supportive and safe environment for all employees. The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace environment is equally detrimental. Employees who witness or experience bullying are encouraged to report it to their supervisor or Human Resources. The Company is committed to fostering a supportive and safe environment for all employees. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to

uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

7.4 Dress Code and Grooming

Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role, location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to determine the appropriateness of an employee's attire and may require an employee to return home to change if their clothing is deemed inappropriate. Time spent changing will not be compensated. Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role, location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to determine the appropriateness of an employee's attire and may require an employee to return home to change if their clothing is deemed inappropriate. Time spent changing will not be compensated. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is

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7.5 Drug and Alcohol-Free Workplace

The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations, such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations, such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management

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8. Attendance and Leave Policies

8.1 Working Hours and Attendance

Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs.

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8.2 Paid Time Off (PTO)

The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and

Company policy. The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

8.3 Sick Leave

In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company

may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

8.4 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform

essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250 hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250 hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

8.5 Bereavement Leave

The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every

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9. Compensation and Performance

9.1 Payroll Practices

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from

Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

9.2 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines

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9.3 Performance Reviews

The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other employment decisions. The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other

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9.4 Salary Administration

The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary discussions are confidential between the employee, their manager, and Human Resources. Pay increases are not guaranteed and are typically based on merit, promotions, or significant changes in job responsibilities. The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary

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10. Technology and Information Security

10.1 Acceptable Use of Technology

The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy

when using Company technology. The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

10.2 Social Media Policy

The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential

or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the social media policy may lead to disciplinary action. The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the social media policy may lead to disciplinary action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

10.3 Confidentiality and Data Protection

During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees

are obligated to maintain the strict confidentiality of this information and use it only for legitimate business purposes. Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals, either internally or externally, without proper authorization. This obligation of confidentiality continues even after the employee's employment with the Company has ended. Employees must take all reasonable precautions to protect confidential information from unauthorized access, loss, or theft. This includes securing physical documents, using strong passwords, and being cautious of phishing scams or social engineering attempts. During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees are obligated to maintain the strict confidentiality of this information and use it only for legitimate business purposes. Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals, either internally or externally, without proper authorization. This obligation of confidentiality continues even after the employee's employment with the Company has ended. Employees must take all reasonable precautions to protect confidential information from unauthorized access, loss, or theft. This includes securing physical documents, using strong passwords, and being cautious of phishing scams or social engineering attempts. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to

uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

10.4 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen, or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen, or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making

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11. Introduction and Purpose

11.1 Purpose of the Handbook

The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, or deviate from these policies as circumstances dictate. This document supersedes all previous employee handbooks and any inconsistent verbal or written policy statements. The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves

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11.2 At-Will Employment

Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company, other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company, other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the

authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

11.3 Equal Employment Opportunity

The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to

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11.4 Disability Accommodations

In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to

providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

12. Workplace Conduct

12.1 Code of Conduct

The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act

with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

12.2 Anti-Harassment Policy

The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent

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12.3 Anti-Bullying Policy

The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace environment is equally detrimental. Employees who witness or experience bullying are encouraged to report it to their supervisor or Human Resources. The Company is committed to fostering a supportive and safe environment for all employees. The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace environment is equally detrimental. Employees who witness or experience bullying are encouraged to report it to their supervisor or Human Resources. The Company is committed to fostering a supportive and safe environment for all employees. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment.

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12.4 Dress Code and Grooming

Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role, location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to determine the appropriateness of an employee's attire and may require an employee to return home to change if their clothing is deemed inappropriate. Time spent changing will not be compensated. Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role, location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to

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12.5 Drug and Alcohol-Free Workplace

The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations, such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are

permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations, such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

13. Attendance and Leave Policies

13.1 Working Hours and Attendance

Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt

operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

13.2 Paid Time Off (PTO)

The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of

service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

13.3 Sick Leave

In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

13.4 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250 hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250 hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will

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13.5 Bereavement Leave

The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company

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14. Compensation and Performance

14.1 Payroll Practices

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our

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14.2 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for

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14.3 Performance Reviews

The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other employment decisions. The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous,

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14.4 Salary Administration

The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary discussions are confidential between the employee, their manager, and Human Resources. Pay increases are not guaranteed and are typically based on merit, promotions, or significant changes in job responsibilities. The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance,

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15. Technology and Information Security

15.1 Acceptable Use of Technology

The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate,

offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

15.2 Social Media Policy

The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content

related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the social media policy may lead to disciplinary action. The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the social media policy may lead to disciplinary action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

15.3 Confidentiality and Data Protection

During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees are obligated to maintain the strict confidentiality of this information and use it only for legitimate business purposes. Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals, either internally or externally, without proper authorization. This obligation of confidentiality continues even after the employee's employment with the Company has ended. Employees must take all reasonable precautions to protect confidential information from unauthorized access, loss, or theft. This includes securing physical documents, using strong passwords, and being cautious of phishing scams or social engineering attempts.

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15.4 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen, or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen, or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational

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16. Introduction and Purpose

16.1 Purpose of the Handbook

The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and what they can expect from the organization. This handbook is designed to foster a positive, productive, and safe working environment. It is the responsibility of every employee to read, understand, and comply with the guidelines set forth in this document. While this handbook attempts to cover a wide range of scenarios, it cannot anticipate every situation that may arise. Therefore, the Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, or deviate from these policies as circumstances dictate. This document supersedes all previous employee handbooks and any inconsistent verbal or written policy statements. The purpose of this Employee Handbook is to provide a comprehensive guide to the policies, procedures, and practices of the Company. It serves as a vital resource for all employees, outlining what is expected of them and

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16.2 At-Will Employment

Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will' basis. This means that either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without prior notice. Nothing in this handbook, or in any other Company document, creates a contract of employment for any specific duration. No manager, supervisor, or representative of the Company, other than the Chief Executive Officer, has the authority to enter into any agreement for employment for any specified period or to make any agreement contrary to the at-will employment relationship. Any such agreement must be in writing and signed by the CEO to be valid. Employment with the Company is strictly on an 'at-will'

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16.3 Equal Employment Opportunity

The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to

discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. The Company is an equal opportunity employer. We are committed to providing a work environment that is free from discrimination and harassment based on race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, marital status, or veteran status. This commitment applies to all aspects of employment, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, benefits, transfer, and termination. All employment decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and business needs. The Company strictly prohibits any form of unlawful discrimination and expects all employees to uphold this standard. Any employee who believes they have been subjected to discrimination should report it immediately to Human Resources. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

16.4 Disability Accommodations

In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process.

During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. In accordance with applicable laws, the Company is committed to providing reasonable accommodations to qualified individuals with disabilities. A reasonable accommodation is any modification or adjustment to a job or the work environment that enables a qualified applicant or employee with a disability to participate in the application process or to perform essential job functions. Employees requiring an accommodation must contact Human Resources to initiate an interactive process. During this process, the Company and the employee will work together to identify potential accommodations. The Company is not required to provide an accommodation if it would impose an undue hardship on the operation of the business. All medical information gathered during this process will be kept strictly confidential. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

17. Workplace Conduct

17.1 Code of Conduct

The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. The Company expects all employees to conduct themselves in a professional, ethical, and responsible manner at all times. This includes treating colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public with respect and courtesy. Employees are expected to act with integrity, honesty, and transparency in all business dealings. Actions that harm the Company's reputation, disrupt operations, or violate laws and regulations are strictly prohibited. The Code of Conduct serves as a foundational expectation for daily interactions and decision-making. Violations of the Code of Conduct, regardless of the severity, may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. We believe that a positive workplace culture is built on mutual respect and shared responsibility. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a

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17.2 Anti-Harassment Policy

The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. The Company is dedicated to maintaining a workplace that is free of harassment. Harassment is defined as unwelcome conduct that is based on race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy), national origin, age, disability, or genetic information. This includes both sexual harassment and non-sexual harassment. Harassment becomes unlawful when enduring the offensive conduct becomes a condition of continued employment, or the conduct is severe or pervasive enough to create a work environment that a reasonable person would consider intimidating, hostile, or abusive. Examples of prohibited conduct include offensive jokes, slurs, epithets or name-calling, physical assaults or threats, intimidation, ridicule or mockery, insults or put-downs, offensive objects or pictures, and interference with work performance. The Company will promptly investigate all reports of harassment and take appropriate corrective action. This

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17.3 Anti-Bullying Policy

The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace environment is equally detrimental. Employees who witness or experience bullying are encouraged to report it to their supervisor or Human Resources. The Company is committed to fostering a supportive and safe environment for all employees. The Company defines bullying as repeated, health-harming mistreatment of one or more persons (the targets) by one or more perpetrators. It is abusive conduct that includes threatening, humiliating, or intimidating behaviors, work interference or sabotage that prevents work from getting done, or verbal abuse. Bullying behavior is unacceptable in the workplace and will not be tolerated. Unlike harassment, bullying may not always be based on a protected characteristic, but its impact on the target and the workplace

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17.4 Dress Code and Grooming

Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role, location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to determine the appropriateness of an employee's attire and may require an employee to return home to change if their clothing is deemed inappropriate. Time spent changing will not be compensated. Employees are expected to present a professional, neat, and well-groomed appearance at all times. The specific dress code requirements may vary depending on the employee's role,

location, and the nature of their interactions with clients or the public. However, basic standards of personal hygiene and appropriate attire apply to everyone. Clothing should be clean, in good repair, and suitable for a business environment. Unacceptable attire includes, but is not limited to, overly revealing clothing, clothing with offensive slogans or imagery, flip-flops, and athletic wear (unless specifically permitted for certain roles or events). Management reserves the right to determine the appropriateness of an employee's attire and may require an employee to return home to change if their clothing is deemed inappropriate. Time spent changing will not be compensated. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

17.5 Drug and Alcohol-Free Workplace

The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations,

such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. The Company is committed to providing a safe, healthy, and productive work environment. The use, possession, distribution, sale, or being under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol while on Company premises, while conducting Company business, or while operating Company vehicles is strictly prohibited. Prescription medications are permitted, provided they do not impair the employee's ability to safely and effectively perform their essential job functions. If an employee's use of prescription medication poses a safety risk, they must notify Human Resources. The Company reserves the right to require drug or alcohol testing in certain situations, such as post-accident, reasonable suspicion, or randomly for safety-sensitive positions, in accordance with applicable state and federal laws. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

18. Attendance and Leave Policies

18.1 Working Hours and Attendance

Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. Regular and punctual attendance is essential for the smooth operation of the Company. Employees are expected to be at their designated workstations, ready to begin work, at the start of their scheduled shift. Standard office hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM, though individual schedules may vary based on department needs. Employees must notify their supervisor as far in advance as possible if they anticipate being late or absent. Unscheduled absences, frequent tardiness, or failure to properly report an absence (a 'no-call/no-show') disrupt operations and place an undue burden on colleagues. Such behavior will result in disciplinary action. Three consecutive days of unreported absence will be considered job abandonment and voluntary resignation. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company

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18.2 Paid Time Off (PTO)

The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. The Company recognizes the importance of work-life balance and provides eligible employees with Paid Time Off (PTO). PTO combines vacation, personal days, and sick leave into a single bank of time that employees can use at their discretion, subject to supervisor approval. PTO accrues based on an employee's length of service and employment status (full-time vs. part-time). Employees must request scheduled PTO in advance using the Company's time-tracking system. Unscheduled PTO (e.g., for sudden illness or emergencies) should be reported as soon as possible. The Company encourages employees to use their PTO for rest, relaxation, and personal matters. Unused PTO may be carried over to the following year up to a specified maximum limit, after which it will be forfeited. Upon termination of employment, accrued but unused PTO will be paid out according to state law and Company policy. This policy is strictly enforced and is a

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18.3 Sick Leave

In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. In addition to PTO, the Company may provide dedicated sick leave in compliance with applicable local and state laws. Sick leave is intended to be used for an employee's own illness, injury, or medical appointments, or to care for a sick family member. Employees must notify their supervisor promptly when they need to use sick leave. For absences extending beyond three consecutive days, the Company may require a doctor's note certifying the need for the absence and clearing the employee to return to work. Abuse of sick leave, such as using it for non-medical reasons, is a serious violation of Company policy and will result in disciplinary action. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our

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18.4 Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250 hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. The Company complies fully with the Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA). Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave in a 12-month period for specified family and medical reasons. These reasons include the birth or adoption of a child, caring for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition, or a serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform essential job functions. To be eligible, an employee must have worked for the Company for at least 12 months and have at least 1,250

hours of service during the 12 months prior to the leave. During FMLA leave, the Company will maintain the employee's health benefits under the same terms and conditions as if they had not taken leave. Employees must provide at least 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

18.5 Bereavement Leave

The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. The Company offers paid bereavement leave to support employees who have experienced the loss of an immediate family member. Employees are typically granted up to three to five days of paid leave, depending on the relationship to the deceased and the location of the funeral services. Immediate

family members are generally defined as a spouse, domestic partner, child, parent, sibling, grandparent, or grandchild, including step-relations and in-laws. Employees requesting bereavement leave should notify their supervisor as soon as possible. The Company may request documentation, such as an obituary or funeral program, to verify the need for leave. Additional unpaid leave or use of PTO may be requested if further time is needed. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

19. Compensation and Performance

19.1 Payroll Practices

Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement

plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. Employees are paid on a bi-weekly basis. Paydays are typically every other Friday. If a payday falls on a Company-recognized holiday, paychecks will be distributed on the preceding workday. Employees are strongly encouraged to enroll in direct deposit for secure and timely payment. The Company is legally required to make certain deductions from employee paychecks, including federal, state, and local taxes, as well as Social Security and Medicare contributions. Employees may also authorize voluntary deductions, such as health insurance premiums, retirement plan contributions, or charitable donations. Employees should review their pay stubs regularly and report any discrepancies to the Payroll Department immediately. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

19.2 Overtime

Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized

overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. Non-exempt employees are eligible for overtime pay in accordance with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state laws. Overtime is paid at a rate of one and one-half times the employee's regular hourly rate for all hours worked in excess of 40 hours in a single workweek. All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor before the work is performed. Working unauthorized overtime is a violation of Company policy and may result in disciplinary action, although the unauthorized time will still be compensated. Exempt employees, who are typically salaried professionals, managers, or executives, are not eligible for overtime pay. Exempt status is determined by job duties and salary level, not by job title. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

19.3 Performance Reviews

The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the

employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other employment decisions. The Company believes that regular feedback is essential for employee growth and development. Performance reviews are typically conducted on an annual basis. These reviews provide an opportunity for managers and employees to discuss the employee's performance over the past year, set goals for the upcoming year, identify areas for improvement, and discuss career aspirations. While the annual review is a formal process, managers are encouraged to provide continuous, informal feedback throughout the year. The results of the performance review are documented and placed in the employee's personnel file. Performance reviews play a significant role in determining merit-based pay increases, promotions, and other employment decisions. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

19.4 Salary Administration

The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary discussions are confidential between the employee, their manager, and Human Resources. Pay increases are not guaranteed and are typically based on merit, promotions, or significant changes in job responsibilities. The Company strives to provide a competitive compensation package that attracts, retains, and motivates highly qualified employees. Salary levels are determined based on a variety of factors, including the specific duties and responsibilities of the position, the employee's skills, experience, and performance, internal equity, and market rates for similar positions in the industry and geographic location. The Company reviews its salary structure periodically to ensure it remains competitive and fair. Employees should understand that salary discussions are confidential between the employee, their manager, and Human Resources. Pay increases are not guaranteed and are typically based on merit, promotions, or significant changes in job responsibilities. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The

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20. Technology and Information Security

20.1 Acceptable Use of Technology

The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. The Company provides various technology resources, including computers, software, networks, internet access, email, and communication systems, to assist employees in performing their job duties. These resources are the property of the Company and are intended primarily for business purposes. While incidental personal use is permitted, it must not interfere with the employee's productivity, disrupt the network, or violate any Company policies. Employees are prohibited from using Company technology to view, download, or distribute inappropriate, offensive, or illegal content. The Company reserves the right to monitor all activity on its technology systems, including internet browsing history and email communications, without prior notice. There should be no expectation of privacy when using Company technology. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the

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20.2 Social Media Policy

The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the social media policy may lead to disciplinary action. The Company respects the right of employees to use social media for personal expression. However, employees must be mindful of how their online activities reflect on the Company. When participating in online discussions or posting content related to the Company, its products, services, clients, or competitors, employees must clearly state that their views are their own and do not represent the official stance of the Company. Employees are strictly prohibited from sharing confidential or proprietary information on social media platforms. Furthermore, employees must not engage in online harassment, bullying, or discriminatory behavior directed at colleagues, clients, or vendors. Violations of the

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20.3 Confidentiality and Data Protection

During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees are obligated to maintain the strict confidentiality of this information and use it only for legitimate business purposes. Confidential information must not be disclosed to unauthorized individuals, either internally or externally, without proper authorization. This obligation of confidentiality continues even after the employee's employment with the Company has ended. Employees must take all reasonable precautions to protect confidential information from unauthorized access, loss, or theft. This includes securing physical documents, using strong passwords, and being cautious of phishing scams or social engineering attempts. During the course of employment, employees may have access to confidential, proprietary, or sensitive information belonging to the Company, its clients, vendors, or other employees. This includes financial data, strategic plans, trade secrets, customer lists, employee records, and any other non-public information. Employees

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20.4 Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen,

or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. The Company allows employees to use their personal mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, to access Company email and certain authorized applications. However, this privilege comes with the responsibility of ensuring the security of Company data on these devices. Employees opting to use personal devices for work purposes must agree to the Company's BYOD policy. This policy may require the installation of mobile device management (MDM) software, which allows the Company to enforce security policies, such as strong passwords and encryption, and to remotely wipe Company data from the device if it is lost, stolen, or upon termination of employment. The Company respects the privacy of personal data on the device but retains the right to manage and protect its own corporate data. This policy is strictly enforced and is a cornerstone of our organizational culture. Furthermore, the management team continually reviews these guidelines to ensure they remain current and effective in promoting a healthy workplace environment. Employees are encouraged to seek clarification from Human Resources if any aspect of this policy is unclear. It is imperative that all staff members integrate these principles into their daily routines and decision-making processes. Consistent adherence to these standards not only protects the company but also fosters a culture of mutual respect and professionalism among all team members. Disciplinary measures will be applied uniformly to ensure fairness and compliance across all departments. The company values the commitment of every employee to uphold these standards, which are vital for our collective success and long-term sustainability.

Acknowledgment of Receipt

I acknowledge that I have received a copy of the Company Employee Handbook. I understand that it is my responsibility to read and comply with the policies

contained in this handbook and any revisions made to it. I understand that this handbook is not a contract of employment and that my employment is on an at-will basis. I further understand that the Company reserves the right to change, modify, or delete any of the policies or benefits described in this handbook at any time, with or without notice.

Employee Name (Printed)

Employee Signature

Date